

Kenneth Bunker, PhD

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ORCID · ResearchGate · Google Scholar · LinkedIn · Web of Science

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Associate Professor, Department of Economics and Government, San Sebastián University *2023–present*

Director, Democracy and Government Lab, San Sebastián University

PREVIOUS POSITIONS

Visiting Scholar, Department of Economics, University of Verona, Italy *2025–2026*

Visiting Professor, Department of Languages, Literature and Culture, University of Bergamo, Italy *2022*

Visiting Professor, Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan, Italy *2019*

Visiting Professor, Department of Political Sciences, Sapienza University, Rome, Italy *2018–2019*

Assistant Professor, Government Department, Central University, Santiago, Chile *2016–2018*

EDUCATION

PhD, Political Science, London School of Economics and Political Science *2016*

MRes, Political Science, London School of Economics and Political Science *2011*

MA, Political Science, San Diego State University *2010*

BA, Political Science, Universidad Diego Portales *2007*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Presidential democracies, political institutions, elections, electoral systems, political parties, party systems, coalitions, strategic voting, spatial maps, ideology, public opinion, and electoral forecasting.

AWARDS AND HONORS

Maria Braun WAPOR Latin America Prize for Best Paper *2023*

La Segunda, Most Influential Twitter Users of Chile in Politics *2016*

El Mercurio, 100 Young Leaders of Chile Under 35 *2012*

PUBLICATIONS

Full list available on Google Scholar and ORCID.

Book

Bunker, K. 2025. *Chile's Transformation Amidst Change. The Theseus Paradox*. Palgrave Macmillan (Springer Nature).

Peer-Reviewed Articles

Bunker, K. Forthcoming 2026. "Electoral Reform and Party-System Fragmentation. Diminishing Marginal Effects and Vote to Seat Conversion Limits in Chile's Concurrent Local Elections." *Local Government Studies*.

Bunker, K. 2026. "Challenging Conventional Wisdom in New Democracies. Social Diversity, Electoral Rules, and Party System Fragmentation in Chile." *Election Law Journal, Rules, Politics, and Policy* 25(1), 56–78.

doi.org/10.1089/elj.2024.0064

Bunker, K. 2025. "Electoral Forecasting in Volatile Party System Settings. Assessing and Improving Pre-Election Poll Predictions in Italy." *Social Science Computer Review*.

doi.org/10.1177/08944393251328309

Bunker, K. 2025. "Mapping Party Systems Over Time. A Spatial Distribution of Ideological Competition in Chile." *Journal of Political Ideologies*.

doi.org/10.1080/13569317.2025.2452179

Bunker, K., and G. Negretto. 2024. "The Party System Effects of Unstable Electoral Rules. Evidence from New Democracies in Latin America." *Party Politics* 30(6), 1126–1142.

doi.org/10.1177/13540688231196111

Bunker, K. 2022. "Forecasting Two-Horse Races in New Democracies. Accuracy, Precision, and Error." *Revista Latinoamericana de Opinión Pública* 11(1), 81–108.

doi.org/10.14201/rlop.25374

Bunker, K. 2021. "The Two-Stage Model to Forecast Elections in New Democracies." *International Journal of Forecasting* 36(4), 1407–1419.

doi.org/10.1016/j.ijforecast.2020.02.004

Bunker, K. 2021. "The Age Cleavage. Cultural Backlash in Chile." *América Latina Hoy* 87, 1–26.

Bunker, K., and D. Brieba. 2019. "Voter Equalization and Turnout Bias After Electoral Reform. Evidence from Chile's Voluntary Voting Law." *Latin American Politics and Society* 61(4), 23–46.

doi.org/10.1017/lap.2019.23

Bunker, K. 2019. "Why Do Parties Cooperate in Presidentialism? Electoral and Government Coalition Formation in Latin America." *Revista de Estudios Políticos* 186(4), 171–199.

doi.org/10.18042/cepc/rep.186.06

Bunker, K. 2018. "The 2017 Elections and the Fragmentation of the Party System in Chile." *Revista Chilena de Derecho y Ciencia Política* 9(2), 204–229.

doi.org/10.7770/RCHDYCP-V9N2-ART1823

Bunker, K., and S. Bauchowitz. 2016. "Electoral Forecasting and Public Opinion Tracking in Latin America. An Application to Chile." *Revista Política* 54(2), 221–237.

Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2015. "Incumbency Advantage and Tenure Length in the Chilean Chamber of Deputies, 1989–2009." *Revista de Ciencia Política* 35(2), 251–271.

Bunker, K. 2014. "The 2013 Presidential and Legislative Elections in Chile." *Electoral Studies* 34(2), 346–348.

doi.org/10.1016/j.electstud.2013.12.005

Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2013. "Latin American Political Outsiders, Revisited. The Case of Marco Enríquez-Ominami in Chile, 2009." *Journal of Politics in Latin America* 5(2), 3–35.

doi.org/10.1177/1866802X1300500201

Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2010. "Explicando la Desproporcionalidad en Latinoamérica. Magnitud de Distrito, Malapportionment y Fragmentación del Sistema de Partidos." *Revista Española de Ciencia Política* 23(1), 83–112.

Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2010. "Democracia Comunal en Chile, 1992–2008." *Política y Gobierno* 17(2), 243–278.

Book Chapters

Alenda, S., M.A. López, K. Bunker, and N. Miranda. 2024. "From Gattopardismo to Ideational Change within the Chilean Right." In *The Reorganization of the Latin American Right*, edited by A. Borges, R. Lloyd, and G. Vommaro. Cambridge University Press.

doi.org/10.1017/9781009427432.011

Bunker, K., and J. Polga-Hecimovich. 2025. "Representation and Party Dynamics. The Interplay of Electoral Systems, Social Cleavages, and Political Ideas in Chile." In *La Democracia y sus Desafíos en el Cambio de Época*. Tirant Lo Blanch.

Bunker, K., and R. Cancino. Forthcoming. "Efecto del Sistema Electoral en la Distorsión entre el Porcentaje de Votos y el Porcentaje de Escaños en el Congreso." In *El Imperio Contraataca. El Retorno de la Derecha al Poder en Chile en las Elecciones de 2017*.

Acevedo, S., and K. Bunker. 2017. "Reelección y Carreras Legislativas en la Cámara de Diputados, 1990–2014." In *El Tsunami Electoral de 2013 en Chile*, edited by M. Morales, P. Navia, and C. Garrido. Universidad Diego Portales, 271–290.

Bunker, K. 2012. "Modificaciones y Reformas al Sistema Electoral Municipal en Chile, 1992–2008." In *Democracia Municipal en Chile, 1992–2012*, edited by M. Morales and P. Navia. Universidad Diego Portales, 39–48.

Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2012. "La Incumbencia y Reelección de Alcaldes en Chile, 1992–2004." In *Democracia Municipal en Chile, 1992–2012*, edited by M. Morales and P. Navia. Universidad Diego Portales, 49–64.

Bunker, K. 2010. "Cambio y Continuidad en la Cámara de Diputados, 1989–2014." In *El Sismo Electoral de 2009*, edited by M. Morales and P. Navia. Universidad Diego Portales, 185–201.

- Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2010. “El Votante Díscolo.” In *Chile 2009. Percepciones y Actitudes Sociales, 5to Informe de Encuesta Nacional ICSO-UDP*. ICSO-UDP, 121–132.
- Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2009. “Duración de las Carreras de Alcaldes 1992–2008.” In *Genoma Electoral Chileno*, edited by P. Navia, M. Morales, and R. Briceño. Universidad Diego Portales, 261–274.
- Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2007. “Índice de Complejidad en las 52 Comunas de la Región Metropolitana.” In *La Reforma Municipal en la Mira*. Expansiva, 31–41.

Book Reviews

- Bunker, K. 2021. Review of *Coalitional Presidentialism in Comparative Perspective*, by P. Chaisty, N. Cheeseman, and T.J. Power. *Party Politics* 27(2), 385–386.
- Bunker, K. 2019. Review of *Cultural Backlash. Trump, Brexit, and Authoritarian Populism*, by P. Norris and R. Inglehart. *Democratization* 26(7), 1323–1325.
- Bunker, K. 2019. Review of *Latin American Elections. Choice and Change*, by R. Nadeau et al. *Journal of Latin American Studies* 51(3), 721–723.
- Bunker, K. 2019. Review of *Party Systems in Latin America*, edited by S. Mainwaring. *Democratization* 26(3), 554–555.
- Bunker, K. 2019. Review of *Votes from Seats. Logical Models of Electoral Systems*, by M.S. Shugart and R. Taagepera. *Public Choice* 178(1–2), 311–313.

Datasets

- Bunker, K. 2025. *Chilean Political Landscape Dataset*. Harvard Dataverse.
doi.org/10.7910/DVN/NGRY3R
- Bunker, K., C. González Piucol, S. Contreras Ubal, and P. Toro. 2022. *Votaciones Individuales de la Convención Constitucional de Chile*. Tresquintos, Santiago.

Working Papers

- Bunker, K., and C. Bellolio. “Unequal Participation. The Age Gap in Transitional Democracies.”
- Bunker, K., and P. Navia. “The Legislative Behavior of Party Switchers in Institutionalized Party Systems.”
- Bunker, K., and G. Negretto. “Electoral Reforms in Latin America. Interactions Between Party Systems and Electoral Systems.”
- Bunker, K., and J. Polga-Hecimovich. “Changing Party Landscapes. Electoral Reform and Sociological Shifts in Chile.”

Policy Reports and Short Studies

Series in *Ideas*. *Laboratorio Democracia y Gobierno*, San Sebastián University. Selected recent entries below. Full catalog available at the Lab website.

Bunker, K., I. Muñoz, L. Paz, and M. Vargas Barrera. 2026. “¿Cuál es el efecto de la redistribución automática de la magnitud de distrito en el resultado electoral?” *Ideas* 1(25).

Arrieta, F., K. Bunker, and M. Vargas Barrera. 2025. “Debut y despedida en el Congreso de Chile, trayectorias políticas 1989–2025.” *Ideas* 1(24).

Bunker, K., C. Daza, and M. Vargas Barrera. 2025. “Experiencia legislativa en el Congreso de Chile, antigüedad por cohorte 1990–2030.” *Ideas* 1(23).

Bunker, K., L. Galdames, and M. Vargas Barrera. 2025. “Renovación y reemplazo en el Congreso de Chile, patrones de reelección 1989–2025.” *Ideas* 1(22).

Bunker, K., M.F. Mejías, and M. Vargas Barrera. 2025. “Sesgo ideológico de votantes chilenos en el exterior. La burbuja europea y el equilibrio americano.” *Ideas* 1(21).

Bunker, K., M. Vargas Barrera, and J. Vilches. 2025. “Simulación legislativa 2025. Posibles resultados y limitaciones.” *Ideas* 1(20).

Bunker, K., B. Valdés, and M. Vargas Barrera. 2025. “Evolución asimétrica del sistema de partidos de Chile. Una examinación temporal a nivel de distrito.” *Ideas* 1(19).

Bunker, K. 2024. “El aumento de los party switchers en el Congreso Nacional de Chile, 1990–2024.” *Ideas* 1(18).

Bunker, K. 2024. “Inestabilidad gubernamental. Rotación ministerial, duración de gabinetes y equilibrio partidario.” *Ideas* 1(17).

Bunker, K., L. Galdames, and F. Arrieta. 2024. “Patrones de reelección en las elecciones de alcalde de 2024.” *Ideas* 1(16).

Bunker, K., and F. Arrieta. 2024. “Coordinación de coaliciones y partidos en las elecciones regionales y locales de 2024.” *Ideas* 1(15).

Bunker, K., and F. Arrieta. 2024. “El avance de los candidatos independientes en las elecciones locales de 2024.” *Ideas* 1(14).

Bunker, K. 2024. “Una propuesta de reforma política simple que le puede dar gobernabilidad a Chile.” *Ideas* 1(13).

Bunker, K. 2024. “¿Cómo se compara el primer tiempo de Gabriel Boric con presidentes anteriores?” *Ideas* 1(12).

Bunker, K., and H. Jofré. 2024. “¿A qué hora y con qué precisión se conocen los resultados electorales en Chile?” *Ideas* 1(10).

Bunker, K., and T. Olavarria. 2024. “¿A qué velocidad se escrutan los votos en Chile?” *Ideas* 1(9).

Bunker, K. 2023. “¿Cuál fue el nivel de acuerdo en las comisiones del consejo constitucional de 2023?” *Ideas* 1(8).

- Bunker, K. 2024. “¿Cuál fue el nivel de acuerdo en el pleno del consejo constitucional de 2023?” *Ideas* 1(7).
- Bunker, K. 2023. “¿Cuál fue el nivel de acuerdo en el pleno de la convención constitucional de 2021–2022?” *Ideas* 1(6).
- Bunker, K. 2024. “¿Cuál fue el nivel de acuerdo en las comisiones de la convención constitucional de 2021–2022?” *Ideas* 1(5).
- Bunker, K. 2024. “¿Cuáles son los efectos del sistema electoral propuesto por el consejo constitucional de 2023?” *Ideas* 1(4).
- Bunker, K. 2024. “¿Cuáles son los determinantes de la fragmentación partidaria?” *Ideas* 1(3).
- Bunker, K. 2024. “¿Chile tiene demasiados o muy pocos legisladores?” *Ideas* 1(2).
- Bunker, K. 2024. “¿Ha aumentado la fragmentación en el sistema de partidos a través de los años?” *Ideas* 1(1).
- Bunker, K., C. González Piucol, S. Contreras Ubal, and E. Espinosa. 2022. *Resumen y análisis de las elecciones presidenciales y legislativas de Chile 2021*. 157 pp. Tresquintos, Santiago.
- Bunker, K., S. Contreras Ubal, C. González Piucol, and M. Orellana. 2022. *Breve historia de la elección presidencial y legislativa de Chile 2021*. 529 pp. Tresquintos, Santiago.

Other Publications

- Bunker, K. 2018. “Mujeres en el Poder Legislativo de Chile, 1990–2018.” *Documentos de Trabajo Universidad Central*.
- Bunker, K. 2018. “Reelección en el Poder Legislativo de Chile, 1993–2017.” *Documentos de Trabajo Universidad Central*.
- Bunker, K. 2018. “Retiros, Remociones y Renuncias en el Poder Legislativo de Chile, 1990–2018.” *Documentos de Trabajo Universidad Central*.
- Bunker, K. 2008. “Modificaciones y Reformas al Sistema Electoral Municipal en Chile, 1992–2008.” *Documentos de Trabajo ICSO* 1(3).
- Bunker, K. 2008. “El Desempeño Electoral de las Mujeres en las Elecciones Municipales.” *Documentos de Trabajo ICSO* 1(2).
- Bunker, K. 2008. “La Incumbencia y Reelección de Alcaldes en Chile, 1992–2004.” *Documentos de Trabajo ICSO* 1(1).
- Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2007. “Elecciones Municipales y Reelección de Alcaldes en Chile, 1992–2004.” *En Foco (Expansiva)* 125.
- Bunker, K. 2006. “Revisión de Experiencias Internacionales sobre Participación Ciudadana en Políticas Sociales.” *En Foco (Expansiva)* 87.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Bunker, K. 2026. "Ideological Asymmetry and Party System Fragmentation. Evidence from Chile." American Political Science Association Annual Conference, Boston, September 3–6.
- Bunker, K., and M. Vargas. 2026. "The Trade-Offs of Democratic Renewal." European Consortium for Political Research General Conference, Jagiellonian University, September 8–11.
- Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2025. "Breaking Ranks. Party Switching, Electoral Reform, and Legislative Discipline in Chile." Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, April 3–6.
- Bunker, K. 2024. "Institutional Theory, Social Structures, and Equilibrium Cycles." CESRAN International Conference, Venice, October 1–4.
- Bunker, K., and G. Negretto. 2023. "The Party System Effects of Unstable Electoral Rules." Latin American Studies Association Conference, Vancouver, Canada, May 24–27.
- Bunker, K., and G. Negretto. 2022. "The Impact of Electoral System Reform in New Democracies." American Political Science Association Conference, Quebec, Canada, September 15–18.
- Bunker, K. 2020. "A Two-Stage Model to Forecast Elections in New Democracies." 73rd Annual Conference of WAPOR, online, October 6–10.
- Bunker, K., and C. Bellolio. 2019. "The Fourth Wave of Populism in Latin America." Latin American Studies Association Conference, Boston, May 24–27.
- Bunker, K., and C. Bellolio. 2019. "Unequal Participation. The Age Gap in Transitional Democracies." Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, April 4–7.
- Brieba, D., and K. Bunker. 2018. "Voter Equalization and Turnout Bias After Electoral Reform." XIII Congreso Chileno de Ciencia Política, Santiago, October 24–26.
- Bunker, K., and D. Brieba. 2018. "Consequences of Switching from Compulsory Voting to Voluntary Voting." Latin American Studies Association Conference, Barcelona, May 17–27.
- Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2012. "Re-election Rates and Incumbency Advantage in the Chilean Congress, 1990–2010." American Political Science Association Conference, New Orleans, August 30 to September 2.
- Bunker, K., and P. Navia. 2011. "The Presidential Bid of Congressman Enríquez-Ominami in Chile in 2009." Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, March 31 to April 3.
- Bunker, K. 2009. "Explaining Disproportionality in Latin America." International Political Science Association, XXI World Congress, Santiago, Chile, July 12–16.

INVITED TALKS AND SEMINARS

- University of Texas at Austin. "Presidential Election of Chile." *December 2021*
- Columbia University. "The Impact of the 2021 Presidential Election on Chile's *November 2021* Future." Host, M.V. Murillo.

Sabancı University, Brown Bag Seminars. “Revisiting Duverger. Party System Origins in New Democracies.” *October 2021*

Universidad Andrés Bello, Research Committee on Political Sociology. “Book Presentation. Preferential Voting Systems.” Host, S. Alenda. *February 2021*

GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Government of Chile

FONDECYT #1140072, “Patterns of Economic Voting in Latin America.” Co-Researcher. *2014–2016*

FONDECYT #1120638, on legislative and municipal elections in Chile, 1989–2009. Co-Researcher. *2012–2014*

FONDECYT #1085243, on presidential approval in Latin America. Research Assistant. *2008–2010*

Beca Presidente de la República de Chile. Full fees, tuition, and stipend at San Diego State University. *2008–2010*

FONDECYT #1060479, on electoral behavior in Chile 1989–2005. Research Assistant. *2006–2008*

London School of Economics

Student Support Fund, Final Year PhD.

Research Studentship, Department of Government.

Postgraduate Travel Fund.

San Diego State University

State University Grant.

Terhune Grant.

Graduate Scholarship, Department of Political Science.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Universidad Central, Assistant Professor, Government Department. *2016–2018*

London School of Economics, Teaching Assistant, Methodology Institute. *2011–2014*

Universidad de Chile, Adjunct Professor, Instituto de Asuntos Públicos. *2012*

Universidad Diego Portales, Adjunct Professor, Escuela de Ciencia Política. *2012*

San Diego State University, Teaching Assistant, Department of Political Science. *2008–2009*

RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

MEPOP , Núcleo Milenio, Santiago, Chile. Researcher.	<i>2020–present</i>
Observatorio Electoral , UDP, Santiago, Chile. Researcher.	<i>2005–present</i>
Democratic Audit , LSE, London, United Kingdom. Researcher.	<i>2015–2016</i>
Corporación Expansiva , Santiago, Chile. Researcher.	<i>2005–2007</i>

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Tresquintos.cl , political analysis consultancy. Founder and Director.	<i>2010–present</i>
Programa Electoral , electoral analysis institute. Founder and Director.	<i>2017–2018</i>
ElectoralDeathMatch , online election game. Co-Founder and Partner.	<i>2015–present</i>

Media

<i>Las Últimas Noticias</i> , Chilean daily newspaper. Columnist.	<i>2018–present</i>
<i>Ex-Ante</i> , Chilean daily newsletter. Columnist.	<i>2021–present</i>
<i>Televisión Nacional de Chile</i> , public TV station. Commentator.	<i>2020–2021</i>
<i>La Tercera</i> , Chilean daily newspaper. Columnist.	<i>2008–2017</i>
Full archive of columns and media appearances at kennethbunker.github.io/columns .	

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Peer Reviewer

Social Science Computer Review, *Election Law Journal*, *Journal of Politics*, *International Journal of Public Opinion Research*, *International Journal of Sociology*, *Electoral Studies*, *Latin American Politics and Society*, *Journal of Comparative Politics*, *Journal of Politics in Latin America*, *Política y Gobierno*, *Political Research Quarterly*, *Revista de Ciencia Política*, *Revista Latinoamericana de Opinión Pública*, *Revista Chilena de Derecho y Ciencia Política*, *Estudios Públicos (CEP)*, ANID (Chile).

Expert Coder

Chapel Hill Expert Survey, América Latina (CHES-LA); Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem); Electoral Integrity Project; Political Representation, Parties, and Presidents Survey (PREPPS).

Professional Memberships

LASA, APSA, MPSA, WAPOR, WAPOR-LATAM.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical software. Stata, R. **Typesetting.** LaTeX. **Version control.** GitHub.